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Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: CrowdStrike

General Comment

Please see attachment.

Attachments

CrowdStrike AI Action Plan Comments



REQUEST FOR INFORMATION RESPONSE

DEVELOPMENT OF AN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) ACTION PLAN

March 14, 2024

I. INTRODUCTION

In response to the Office of Science and Technology Policy's ("OSTP") request for information on the development of an Artificial Intelligence ("AI") Action Plan ("AI Plan"), CrowdStrike offers the following views.

We approach these questions from the standpoint of a leading international, US-headquartered, cloud-native cybersecurity provider that defends globally distributed enterprises from globally distributed threats. CrowdStrike offers insights informed by multiple practice areas: cyber threat intelligence; proactive hunting, incident response and managed security services; and an AI-powered software-as-a-service cybersecurity platform and marketplace. Accordingly, this perspective is informed by CrowdStrike's role in protecting organizations from data breaches and a variety of other cyber threats.

II. COMMENTS

We appreciate Executive Order 14179 *Removing Barriers to American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence*'s and the OSTP's following efforts to create a comprehensive AI Plan that promotes innovation. The request for information correctly notes that the intersection of AI and cybersecurity is a relevant and timely topic. AI is evolving at a rapid pace and creating benefits, and considerations of risks, across many sectors and aspects of life. The cybersecurity sector is no different with AI enhancing security capabilities while also creating new threats that require mitigation.

We welcome the opportunity to offer several points that may be of value to the OSTP as it drafts the AI Plan.

A. Cybersecurity and AI

While the public discourse around AI has grown exponentially in recent years, AI in cybersecurity is not a new concept. CrowdStrike has deployed AI at scale across tens of

millions of endpoints for prevention, dating back ten years. Other vendors are also experimenting with these tools. As a community, we should continue to leverage AI for cybersecurity use cases.

AI can help improve cybersecurity functions. The use of AI to detect cyber threats is an enormous advantage. Today, security teams demand contextual awareness and visibility from across their entire environments, including within cloud and ephemeral environments, and AI can help defenders process this data and make detections more actionable. AI is the best tool defenders have to identify and prevent zero-day attacks and malware-free attacks, because AI can defeat novel threats based on behavior cues rather than known signatures. AI can also significantly reduce response and mitigation times. This is crucial in an era where attacks can spread across networks in seconds.

AI-native tools provide continuous monitoring and automated scanning for security weaknesses, assisting in vulnerability management. It can prioritize vulnerabilities based on real-world threat intelligence, ensuring resources are focused on the most critical issues. Finally, AI-assisted threat hunting enhances the work of human analysts, combining human intuition with AI's data processing capabilities. This synergy allows for more effective and proactive threat hunting.

Leveraging best-in-class cybersecurity technologies deploying AI is essential to meeting constantly-evolving threats.

B. Adversary Use of AI

Unfortunately, AI is also accessible to potential bad actors. Thwarting AI-enabled attacks can start with understanding how adversaries are currently using AI. One concern is that it enables unsophisticated threat actors to achieve nation-state level cyber capabilities in certain contexts. However, at this point, it does not appear to be broadly elevating threats from actors that are already sophisticated. We anticipate further evolution in the use of AI for defensive and malicious purposes over the coming years.

In CrowdStrike's 2025 *Global Threat Report*, we examined adversary use of AI, particularly generative AI. Generative AI has emerged as an attractive tool for adversaries with a low barrier to entry that makes it widely accessible. Recent advancements in generative AI have enhanced the efficacy of certain cyber operations, particularly those using social engineering. Adversaries increasingly adopted

generative AI throughout 2024, particularly in support of social engineering efforts and high-tempo information operation campaigns.¹ Both were supported by generative AI tools that can create highly convincing outputs without precise prompting, custom model training, or fine-tuning.

In order for the U.S. to maintain its AI cybersecurity advantage and stay ahead of adversaries, U.S. public and private sectors must be encouraged to continue innovating. New requirements or regulations should not stifle innovation and new technologies. Regulating AI, and its use, for the sake of the technology rather than its application is not the best approach to foster innovative solutions to difficult problems. As adversaries continue to evolve and find new ways to target victims, organizations must increase their emphasis on cybersecurity practices that leverage the most effective technologies - and that includes AI.

C. Protection of AI Systems

The request for information raises the important issue of securing AI systems. In fact, CrowdStrike recently published a blog examining this very issue – protecting AI itself.² While AI is instrumental in protecting data, we must also consider the protection of AI systems themselves, including the importance of avoiding silent failures. The following are principles CrowdStrike uses to frame our approach in protecting AI systems.³

- *Data Operations*: Ensuring the integrity of AI models through carefully curated training data. This includes rigorous processes for protecting our corpus against adversarial machine learning attacks.
- *Continuous Improvement*: Constant refinement of models to adapt to new threats. Our adversarial pipeline, for instance, allows us to generate new adversarial samples to train our machine learning models, increasing their effectiveness against evolving threats.
- *Privacy-by-Design*: Developing AI systems with Privacy-by-Design principles in mind. This helps to leverage AI in a manner designed to respect user privacy

¹ 2025 Global Threat Report, CrowdStrike, https://www.crowdstrike.com/explore/2025-global-threat-report?tab.consessionscheduledday=1730400114135003mEeJ&utm_medium=dir

² The Evolving Role of AI in Data Protection, Drew Bagley and Christoph Bausewein, <https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/the-evolving-role-of-ai-in-data-protection/>

³ Ibid.

while delivering robust security.

- *Transparency and Accountability*: Clear documentation of AI systems' capabilities and limitations. This transparency is crucial for building trust with users and complying with emerging AI regulations.

D. Generative AI

There are multiple facets of AI. Traditional AI, including algorithmic machine learning, is widely used today. Generative AI, including Large Language Models (“LLMs”), are increasing in popularity and pose separate but related policy questions. The opportunities and potential risks for each are different. For example, CrowdStrike leverages LLMs to assist analyst workflows and to make other security analyst tasks more efficient. This capability (coined “Charlotte”) utilizes CrowdStrike’s highest-fidelity security data, which includes the trillions of security events captured in the CrowdStrike Threat Graph, asset telemetry from across users, devices, identities, cloud workloads, and threat intelligence. The use of this knowledge base drives efficacy, actionability, and relevance, as well as addresses the risk of “hallucination.”

Further, the natural language interface seeks to make cybersecurity responsibilities more broadly accessible. Our goal with *Charlotte* is to help close the cybersecurity skills gap and improve the response time so users can stay ahead of adversaries – boosting security across organizations. *Charlotte* is transforming the security analyst experience by allowing natural language queries and simplifying complex data analysis, making cybersecurity capabilities more accessible to individuals with less training, as well as making trained analysts more efficient in operating at scale. For example, as security teams race to outpace AI-wielding threat actors, *Charlotte* saves customers more than 40 hours of manual work per week on average by doing initial detection triage on their behalf, bringing capabilities up to expert-level Security Operation Center (“SOC”) triage speed.⁴

Generative AI, like *Charlotte*, can help democratize cybersecurity, allowing users of all skill levels to leverage advanced security capabilities. We view this as especially important given the ongoing shortage in the cybersecurity workforce. Today, we see

⁴ CrowdStrike Leads Agentic AI Innovation in Cybersecurity with Charlotte AI Detection Triage, Elia Zaitsev, <https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/agentic-ai-innovation-in-cybersecurity-charlotte-ai-detection-triage/>

this use of LLMs as one of the most relevant to improving security outcomes in the near- to mid-term.

E. Privacy and AI

The request for information raises data privacy through the lifecycle of an AI system. As mentioned above, we have incorporated “Privacy-by-Design” principles in our use of AI, from the training data that powers AI models to the queries used to automate productivity.⁵ While AI is often framed as posing a risk to privacy, it’s important to recognize that AI is critical for protecting data against cyber threats, thereby becoming critical for modern privacy. AI-powered systems can detect and respond to threats faster and more accurately than traditional methods, making them essential in our defense against sophisticated cyberattacks and data breaches.

III. CONCLUSION

We believe the AI Plan will be a thoughtful analysis of a complex, constantly evolving, policy area - AI. As the AI Plan moves forward and evolves, we recommend continued engagement with stakeholders. Finally, because the underlying technologies evolve faster than law and policy, we recommend that any final framework focus on principles rather than prescriptive requirements and include a mechanism for periodic revisions.

IV. ABOUT CROWDSTRIKE

CrowdStrike (Nasdaq: CRWD), a global cybersecurity leader, has redefined modern security with one of the world’s most advanced cloud-native platforms for protecting critical areas of enterprise risk – endpoints and cloud workloads, identity and data.

Powered by the CrowdStrike Security Cloud and world-class AI, the CrowdStrike Falcon® platform leverages real-time indicators of attack, threat intelligence, evolving adversary tradecraft and enriched telemetry from across the enterprise to deliver hyper-accurate detections, automated protection and remediation, elite threat hunting and prioritized observability of vulnerabilities.

⁵ The Evolving Role of AI in Data Protection, Drew Bagley and Christoph Bausewein, <https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/the-evolving-role-of-ai-in-data-protection/>

Purpose-built in the cloud with a single lightweight-agent architecture, the Falcon platform delivers rapid and scalable deployment, superior protection and performance, reduced complexity and immediate time-to-value.

CrowdStrike: We stop breaches.

Learn more: <https://www.crowdstrike.com/>.

CONTACT

We would welcome the opportunity to discuss these matters in more detail. Public policy inquiries should be made to:

Drew Bagley CIPP/E

VP & Counsel, Privacy and Cyber Policy

Elizabeth Guillot

Senior Manager, Public Policy

Email:



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